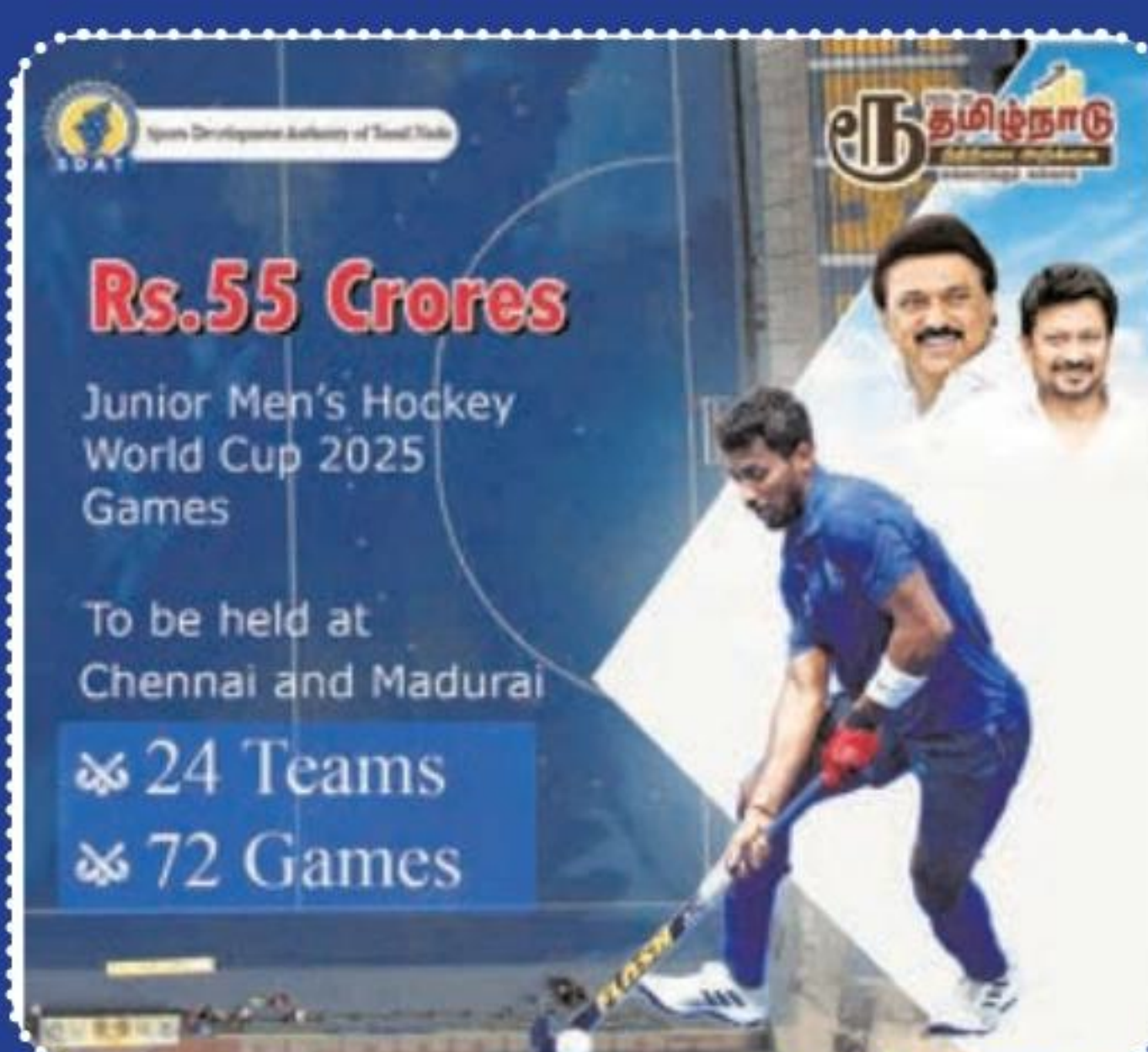




The Sports Hostels run by SDAT have long been a stronghold for developing sporting talent across the state. Excitingly, a new three-storyed Sports Hostel is set to be built in Madurai, aimed at nurturing aspiring athletes. Furthermore, another modern Sports Hostel will soon rise next to the newly inaugurated Kalaingar Centenary Boxing Academy in Gopalapuram, Chennai. Alongside these new infrastructure projects, several existing facilities are also gearing up for impressive transformations. The Integrated Sports Complex at Jawaharlal Nehru Indoor Stadium is scheduled for significant enhancements, while the Anna Swimming Pool in Chepauk will be upgraded to boost its appeal and functionality. Additionally, the iconic Nehru Stadium in Coimbatore and the SDAT Mogappair Complex are both set for comprehensive revamps, promising to rejuvenate these iconic venues and elevate the overall sporting experience for athletes and fans alike.

GIVING WINGS TO SPORTING ASPIRATIONS

Athletes trained under the Sports Hostels of SDAT have gone on to secure medals at both national and international levels. To further support these talents in their quest for excellence, this year's budget has launched an innovative Competition Exposure Grant. This initiative aims to ease the financial pressures tied to participating in various sporting events by covering essential expenses such as travel, accommodation, entry fees, and other related costs. By doing this, it paves the way for more athletes to compete, significantly boosting their chances of winning medals and raising the profile of sports in the state.

The Player Support Schemes of SDAT have played a crucial role in fostering a wealth of talent in the state. In a proactive move to enhance the impact of these initiatives, the budget has announced plans to considerably increase the number of beneficiaries. Specifically, the ELITE Scheme will expand from 25 to 30 beneficiaries, allowing more athletes to access the resources they need. Additionally, the Mission International Medals Scheme (MIMS) will see its athlete roster grow from 75 to an ambitious 125. Moreover, the Champions Development Scheme (CDS) is set for significant expansion, with the number of beneficiaries set to double from 100 to 200 in the upcoming financial year. Through this move, SDAT is paving the way for a brighter future in sports, ensuring that the state and the country continue to shine on the global stage.

To offset the financial stress faced by athletes who sustain injuries while competing at State and National levels—such as in the National Games, National Championships, All India Inter-University Games, Khelo India Youth Games, and Khelo India University Games, as well

as other events organised by recognized federations — a comprehensive Insurance Scheme has been proposed. This initiative aims to provide coverage for 25,000 athletes participating in these competitions, allowing them to concentrate on their performance without the added concern of potential medical expenses.

PREFERRED DESTINATION: WHERE THE WORLD COMES TO PLAY

Tamil Nadu has firmly established itself as the preferred destination for international sporting events, showcasing its vibrant culture and hospitality to the world. Continuing this illustrious trend, the state is set to host the highly anticipated Junior Men's Hockey World Cup 2025, a monumental event that promises to be one of the biggest highlights of the sporting calendar.

Following closely, the Squash World Cup 2025 will take place, building on the successful hosting of the Squash World Cup 2023, where the thrills of world-class competition captivated fans. Moreover, Tamil Nadu will also illuminate the e-sports landscape with the Chennai e-Sports Global Championship—a groundbreaking event tailored by the state to become the largest e-sports tournament in the country, drawing top teams from around the globe to compete for glory and recognition.

Additionally, the region will play host to the Asian Surfing Championship and the Asian Youth Sailing Championship, both of which promise to bring together the best young talents and seasoned professionals from across Asia, enhancing the competitive landscape. Rounding out the line-up is the renowned IRONMAN Challenge, a gruelling test of endurance that showcases the spirit of athleticism and determination. With such a diverse array of events, Tamil Nadu is poised to make an indelible mark on the global sports stage.

In addition, the state is poised to proudly host the Tamil Nadu Sports Science Conclave (TASCon 2.0), a significant event that builds upon the remarkable success of the inaugural TASCon held in 2023. This upcoming conclave promises to be an exciting platform for discussions, innovations, and advancements in sports science, further enhancing the region's reputation as a hub for excellence in sports.

The 2025-26 Budget for Youth Welfare and Sports Development in Tamil Nadu is a bold and visionary step toward transforming the state into a powerhouse of sports and youth empowerment. By implementing these transformative initiatives, Tamil Nadu is not just investing in sports—it is investing in its future champions, leaders, and changemakers, ensuring that the state emerges as a national and global contender in the world of sports and youth development.